4. Stay away from damaged power lines, falling trees and flood water.
5. Boil and purify water before drinking.

8.3.4 Flood

Flood destructions have always brought miseries to numerous people, especially in rural areas. Flood results in the outbreak of serious epidemics, specially malaria and cholera. Simultaneously, scarcity of water also arises. It has a drastic effect on agricultural produce. Sometimes, water remains standing over large areas for long span of time hampering the Rabi crops.

India is one of the most flood prone country in the world. The principal reasons for flood lie in the very nature of natural ecological systems in this country, namely, the monsoon, the highly silted river systems and the steep highly erodible mountains, particularly those of the Himalayan ranges. The average rainfall in India is 1,150 mm with significant variation across the country. The annual rainfall along the western coast and the Western Ghats, Khasi hills and over most of the Brahmaputra valley amounts to more than 2,500 mm. Twenty-three of the states (29) and union territories (7) in the country are subject to floods and 40 million hectares of land, roughly one-eighth of the country's geographical area, is prone to floods. The National Flood Control Program was launched in the country in 1954.

Fact File

Tropical Cyclone Vardha hit Chennai on 12th December, 2016. National Disaster Management Authority (NDMA) reports that at least 10 people have died in Tamil Nadu.

Maximum sustained wind speeds of over 130 km/h was recorded, and the storm has caused severe damage to parts of the city of Chennai. Over 4,000 trees have been uprooted, power lines downed and buildings damaged.



NDRF teams clear up damage after Cyclone Vardha. Photo: NDRF

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